

Brain-Based Mental Health Community

Trust-Based Relational Intervention (TBRI) Feedback

NAME

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DATE

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Review the live website before providing feedback:

<https://tcfasd.github.io/Brain-Based-Mental-Health-/handout-therapy-guide.html>

All ages | Brain-Based Fit: Very Strong (designed for this)

What It Asks the Brain to Do:

TBRI is a trauma-informed, attachment-based intervention built on three principles:

- Connecting Principles: Activate the social engagement system — build felt safety through attunement, eye contact, healthy touch, and playful engagement
- Empowering Principles: Address the body's physiological needs that directly affect brain function — blood sugar regulation, sensory needs, hydration, and sleep. TBRI is unique in explicitly addressing the body's physical state as a driver of behavior.
- Correcting Principles: Use "connected correction" — maintaining the relationship while setting boundaries. The brain learns it can be redirected without being rejected.

Caregiver Involvement:

Extremely high. TBRI is fundamentally a caregiver-training approach. Caregivers learn all three principle sets and implement them in daily life. TBRI also trains professionals, teachers, and entire organizations.

How to Know If It Might Be a Good Fit:

- Your child comes from a "hard place" — trauma, foster care, adoption, institutional care, or prenatal substance exposure
- Your child has attachment difficulties, sensory needs, or regulation difficulties
- You want a comprehensive framework that addresses body, relationship, AND behavior together
- You are adopting or fostering and want a trauma-informed parenting framework from the start

Brain-Based Consideration

:TBRI was designed with prenatal substance exposure explicitly in mind. The Empowering Principles directly address blood sugar dysregulation and sensory processing — issues common in FASD that are often missing from other therapies. TBRI's research notes that children with histories of prenatal substance exposure often have significant changes to insulin receptor sites, making them subject to dramatic behavioral shifts when blood sugar drops. This physiological awareness is critical for families navigating brain-based differences.

1. Is what is written accurate?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Yes

Caregivers should be prepared to address their own histories while learning TBRI.

2. Is there additional information that you think caregivers should know about Trust-Based Relational Intervention (TBRI)?

FYI: Colon typo in green box before TBRI

Thank you for your feedback!